

- You get 5 GB of free cloud storage so that you can backup all your important data into the cloud. You can pay a nominal sum to increase the amount of storage available to you.
- Just like MobileMe, all your calendar appointments, emails, notes, and Safari bookmarks are now synced across all devices.
- Pages, Numbers, Keynote work simultaneously. Inasmuch, they are updated instantly so that you can work on your documents without any lag.
- One of the most underrated features is the 'Find My iDevice' app. Losing such an expensive device would pinch anybody's pocket, so Apple included an app which you can use to locate your Apple device so long as it is synced with iCloud.
- Thanks to iCloud, you can take a photo or import a photo on one of your iDevices and have it appear on all your other devices. You can view all of them in an app called Photo Stream.
- You can play detective (or a 1984 like Big Brother) with the 'Find My Friends' feature, as it allows you to locate your friends when you meet up with them. It doesn't stop at that, however. If you were so inclined, you could track any of your iOS contacts. You can opt out of this service whenever you feel like it. Phew.
- All your Apps sync and backup automatically into iCloud, so now you have unfettered access to them from any of your devices.

The Cloud Wars: iCloud vs Others

Apart from iCloud, the major players in the Personal Cloud business are Dropbox, Google Drive, and Microsoft OneDrive. The first three are pretty alike so we'll focus on them here:

- **iCloud:** It gives you 5 GB of free storage, and has monthly prices ranging from 1 dollar for 50 GB to 20 dollars for 2 TB. For Apple users, it is the easiest to access. It automatically syncs up all your devices with zero fuss. It operates on the Just Works principle, because it requires little setup, and even little-er effort. It offers a wider range of storage options than its competitors. It is slightly more expensive than its competitors for the 1 TB option. Further, it is still a little clunky. Sometimes it doesn't sync immediately and it takes time for files to appear on other devices. With the creation of their own Cloud Computing Services, Apple aims to eliminate all these glitches from iCloud.
- **Dropbox:** The grand old patriarch in the Cloud game. Dropbox was, for the longest time, the only way for users to backup their data on